

Nothing like sunlight

Micromax may be developing a phone with a built-in solar charger, where 3 hours of charging return 1.5 hours of talktime

**BlackBerry Mobile Fusion**

RIM has launched its enterprise multi-platform device management solution, BlackBerry Mobile Fusion – for BlackBerry, iOS and Android devices

Understanding Ultrabooks

Ultrabooks are all the rage in the laptop and personal computing market right now. Intel expects ultrabooks to occupy around 40 per cent of the total laptops launched in 2012. We conversed with Karen Regis, Intel's Director of Ultrabook Marketing Strategy, to get insights about the big picture

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Karen Regis, Director of Ultrabook Marketing Strategy, Intel

Q Would you agree that the term ultrabook is a marketing gimmick?

Intel expects Ultrabook devices to be as transformational to mobile computing as Intel Centrino Mobile technology was more than eight years ago. Remember, Intel's vision for the Ultrabook entails a multi-year, industry-wide endeavor that will roll out in phases with new experiences and features added over time. It's about driving innovation and integrating capabilities that users want and may not even know yet that they need – much like Centrino helped make Wi-Fi a must-have in laptops. Some of the nearer term innovations we expect to see include hybrid devices (both tablet and laptop functionality) as well as technologies like touch and sensors. Intel is committed to the Ultrabook category, and we're seeing very strong support from our partners as well.

Q How do you respond to the criticism that the ultrabook is a desperate attempt to rekindle excitement among laptops, more importantly among consumers more keen on buying a tablet?

Worldwide PC unit shipments continue to grow at double-digit rates. This is one of the reasons for Intel's recent record revenues and earnings. We believe that PCs will continue to play a key role in people's personal computing needs.

At the same time, people have rapidly evolving requirements for personal computing in terms of responsiveness, capabilities, increased security and mobility. Intel aims to help drive these changes. Whether it's a tablet, PC, Ultrabook or hybrids we aim to deliver great experiences that satisfy people's needs, no matter what the device.

Q Is an ultrabook a poor man's MacBook Air?

Intel's vision for Ultrabook devices entails a multi-year, industry-wide endeavor that will roll out in phases where new experiences and features will be added over time. Intel aims with the Ultrabook category to deliver new experiences that people want and will love. Devices coming in the future will blend the best of the laptop experience with aspects of other consumer electronic devices.

Q How has Intel managed to make thin ultrabooks last longer than fatter laptops with bigger and better batteries?

Great battery life is one of the requirements to be called an Ultrabook. Ultrabook devices offer at least 5 hours of battery life with many providing 8 hours or more, even in the sleekest form factors. In general, we expect to

see greater use of Lithium polymer batteries (such as are used in phones) in Ultrabook devices. Intel is focused on driving innovations in battery design and technology in the industry to continually improve the user experience in terms of ever better battery life in ever more attractive designs. This is one of the focus areas of the Ultrabook Fund (read more here: <http://dgit.in/IeZNCd>).

Q Regarding OEMs and various partners, is Intel laying down minimum specifications for ultrabooks to ensure a standard benchmark for end user experience?

Intel works closely with its industry partners to ensure that Ultrabook devices consistently deliver a compelling and unique value proposition to customers. In order for a system to be classified as an Ultrabook and use the Ultrabook trademark, a certain set of guidelines must be followed. The guidelines may evolve over time as new capabilities come to market. A verification process is in place to help ensure the consistent and outstanding experience we aim to deliver.

Q This year marks Intel's first steps into the tablet and smartphone market with Medfield chips. How important is this market to Intel and how does it affect sales of ultrabooks?

I'm not the right person to comment on Medfield, but what I can tell you is that whether it's a tablet, PC, phone or Ultrabook Intel aims to deliver great experiences that satisfy people's needs, no matter what the device.who value certain features more. For example, a gamer may want a desktop system with maximum performance. Or a road warrior may value weight and size as the top feature. We value choice and a spectrum of options for all types of users. **Q**

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